



February 2008

Rich Man's Mag?

I am a Subscriber of *Digit*—my technology navigator. I am from a lower middle class family, and like everyone else I have some wishes to fulfil in my life—one of them is to own a computer. The reason I'm writing this letter is to tell you that you're a "rich person's" magazine. You have no products for customers like myself. I would love it if you reviewed CRTs or 17-inch LCDs, a budget 160 GB hard disk, low priced speakers (Rs 500 to 1,000), etc. I know you cannot test everything that exists in the Indian markets, but once in a while why not test budget phones and the like, to tell us what to buy. Aren't the Nokia 1112, 5070, 6070, 6030, etc., considered to be good phones? I know you have limited pages, but perhaps you can test them for us and tell us which budget products we can buy. I'd like to be able to buy a budget computer, and do not need a quad-core gaming rig. So what about readers like myself? I don't know if you will read this letter or not, but I still would like to thank you for a great magazine.

Antu Kanta
Durgapur, West Bengal

Agent 001

Unhappy Feet

I think *Digit* feels that we're all penguins—experts at Linux. Although Linux is my passion, and I enjoy using the Open SuSE 10.3 that you gave me, I am disappointed with the Linux content on the DVDs. Yes, it's true that your DVDs have the best content, the Linux content is all provided as tarballs. Not all of us can compile from source. I know the basic commands, such as ".configure", "make", and "make install", but many software require special libraries to work. I wish you guys would look at the requirements and provide those libraries as well. At least provide the software manuals, or give us RPM packages. Also, you give us Avast! Home Edition and it's update every month, but I feel that it's not the best free anti-virus. I think Avira and AVG are much better, and you don't even give us the virus definitions for them. Please provide us with updates for the same every month. Still, thanks for providing us with such a variety of software. I would also like to thank you for switching me over to open source. Although I do have a pirated copy of Windows as dual-boot, I'm trying to do everything possible on Linux. I hope Microsoft will forgive me because I am a student and I'm poor, but I promise to either switch over to Linux completely, or buy Windows with my first salary.

Aswin Babu K
Alapuzha, Kerala

We hope Microsoft will forgive you too! We will also try and provide you with executables and RPMs instead of tarballs, which we give so that any users of any Linux distro can compile from source. We're very glad that you're choosing open source over piracy, and hope that more people will continue to do so. Keep writing in, and let us know whether you finally make the switch or when you buy Windows.

Team Digit

Confessions Of A Serial Reader

When I first got your magazine, I committed the blunder of trying to compare it to the others. After a few months of buying them, all I realised was that none of them could beat *Digit*. I was born into a middleclass family, and no one but me has an IT background. I used to work for a hardware vendor, so I picked up a lot on the job. Now, I'm in the music business, but I still use *Digit* to

stay in touch and keep my passion alive. I would suggest that you keep up the good work and add more tutorials and articles about computer education, instead of just product-specific articles. I hope you will forgive my earlier blunder of buying other magazines, and accept me as a member of the *Digit* family.

Vasanth Kumar Jagan Mohan
MD, SA Musicals

We're actually glad you bought those "other" magazines. It's good that you got a first hand look at them and chose us for being better. Unlike jealous spouses, or significant others, we're always forgiving and welcome you back with open arms.

Team Digit

BOO!

My brother has been a "die hard" fan since 2000—when *Digit* was called Chip, and I was in class two. Now I'm in class 10, and we're both fans. This time we actually got your magazine five days earlier than usual, thanks for that. I was terribly disappointed by your mobile phone reviews. I wish you would have compared them the way you normally do, because all the phones seemed to get ratings of 3 or 4. How are we supposed to tell which ones to buy? I would have preferred a comparison test. Still, I have to admit that you have helped me learn technology, and I am considered a "tech consultant" in class. I also liked the article *Settling Differences*, about which is more secure, Linux or Windows!

Akash Agrahari
Lucknow

We're glad that you've followed in your brother's footsteps, and we hope you'll continue to do so. The reason why we did individual reviews for the mobile phones was to bring out finer aspects of all the mobiles. Unlike graphics cards, hard drives, CPUs and the like, it's a lot harder for us to tell you what to like or hate about a phone. We'd rather give each one its due and let you, and all our readers, decide on what best suits their needs. Of course, we also thought about people like you who wanted to compare the phones and wanted detailed scores and feature lists, and provided you with the tables at the end of the article. We're not going to kid ourselves and imagine that we can please you all, but you can rest assured that we'll keep your suggestions in mind for the next test.

Team Digit

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. **Please include your complete address in all communication.**
For subscription queries send an e-mail to help@thinkdigit.com

Inbox

Give Me My Space

I have had a lot of trouble over the past few issues of *Digit*. My problem is that your text and pictures are being placed too close to the bound edges of the magazine. Please provide more of a gap at the bound edges, because, since I have only one hand, I find it difficult to read the magazine. I hope you will consider my request and implement this soon.

Raghu GS
Bengaluru

Wow, it's heartening to see that your disability has not stopped your passion for technology, or for *Digit*. We have forwarded this mail to our designers and they promise to look into the matter, and stop trying to pack in too much content into the bound edges.

Team Digit

Slow Track?

I have been a long-time reader of your magazine, through all its name changes, :). I find *Digit* extremely interesting and useful, but this is the first time I am writing to you. Perhaps this is because I have two small requests. 1) Please add the latest version of OpenOffice.org as soon as possible. 2) Please include the previous month's *Fast Track* book in PDF version on the discs. I would be especially grateful for the second request, because I am tired of my friends "borrowing" the *Fast Track* books, and then never getting it back. Adding the PDF to the subsequent month's DVD will prevent me from having to chase it around my city all month while it's out on its "walk". I can't wait till your December or June issues to get my hands on the PDF versions.

Sandeep M

Well Sandeep, we're sorry to tell you that not only are you doing yourself a great injustice, but us as well. You should consider forcing the subscription form on to your friends, and insisting that they subscribe to *Digit*. Not only will this safeguard your copy of *Digit* and *Fast Track*, it will also be good for all your friends and us as well. As for the *Fast Tracks* in PDF format, we'll see what we can do. Though you have to admit that adding the *Fast Tracks* in PDF to our special issues does make them worth the wait.

Team Digit

I Want More

I am a regular reader of *Digit* since August 2003, and I haven't missed a single issue since. This magazine is simply mind blowing. I keep reading all my magazines throughout the month, and this helps me keep updating my tech knowledge. Although I am very happy with *Digit*, I still have some suggestions: 1) Please increase the size of the Tips & Tricks section. 2) Please add more about Vista, Linux and the latest hardware. 3) Don't give us those old movies in the entertainment section. 4) Provide the latest games, movies and wallpapers in every issue. 5) A Fast Track to DirectX 10. 6) Give us more information on Web sites and freeware. I hope you will consider my suggestions.

Imran
Kashmir

Hmm, so let us get this straight. Basically, you want more Tips & Tricks, more Vista, More Linux, more... well... *Digit*! Although we all wish we could double the size of the content on a regular basis, we're all quite afraid that our families will disown us, our employees will drop of exhaustion, or worse, quit! Jokes apart, we can understand your point of view, and will try and provide you with the overdose of information that you seek. Of course, we have to keep our costs and our health in mind, so all we can promise to do is try our best.

Team Digit

I Want My Big Mac?

I am a fan, and read your magazine faithfully. I loved the article *Settling Differences*, but I feel you should have included Mac from the security angle. Since the Mac is quite a mystery to us PC users, a little information in that regards would have been useful. Please also add more articles about Linux.

Manish Sharma

The article focussed on Linux and Windows mainly because pretty much every desktop in the world runs either a Unix-based OS or Windows. Apple's OS is based on BSD, which is another Unix-based OS. But yes, we will try and include more Mac-centric content.

Team Digit

No, No, NO! Oh Fine...

I'm writing to you after a long time. I used to buy a lot of IT magazines, but now I only buy *Digit*. However, you guys have to make certain improvements. The disc packaging is getting worse. This month's DVD and CD refuse to sit in place because of the poor jewel case. I have also been getting DVDs with a few corrupted files on a more regular basis, and the Entertainment DVD of your anniversary issue did not run at all. I expect better from India's No. 1 magazine! Also, you said you'd provide the missing Google *Fast Track* on the following DVD, but the DVD-Guy forgot—please add it when you can. As for the *Fast Track*, you need to take it to the next level, and add topics such as Adobe Flash, Programming, Dreamweaver, etc. Of course, only criticism and no praise is not fair, so I should tell you that your disk interface is the best of all the magazines. The other magazine's discs do not run on my old computer, but your disc runs perfectly—it's good that you went for usability and not fancy, irritating and heavy interfaces. When I return to my village, where I have 128 MB RAM machines, I don't even bother carrying anything but *Digit*'s discs with me. Please start adding movie trailers again, I loved those. Also, one of my friends is following your advice in the *Tech Careers* section, and is doing well. I thank you on his behalf. Please continue to be our technology navigators! I would write more, but both you and I do not have such luxuries with time...

Inderdeep S

Wow Inderdeep, you've really taken the time to send a feedback letter. We'll look into the DVD jewel case matter, though sometimes a handful might be damaged during packaging and transport. We request you and all our readers to write to help@thinkdigit.com to get free replacements for damaged DVDs. Yes, apparently the "DVD-guy" fell asleep again, and forgot the *Fast Track to Google* PDF again. Seriously though, he was on leave and the rest of us are to blame for that. We'll include it as soon as possible. Thanks for appreciating everything else, and please keep writing in and giving us your valuable suggestions.

Team Digit

